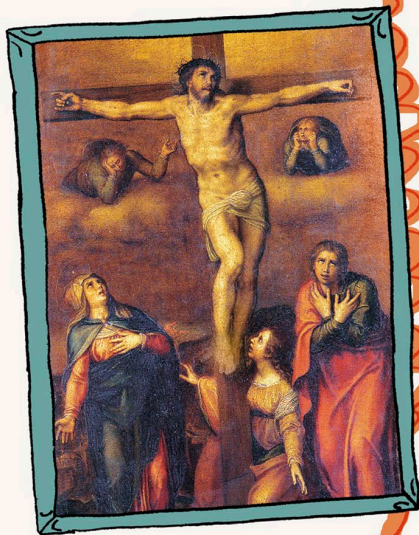


His next undertaking, begun in 1495, was his most ambitious yet. The friars at the Church of Santa Maria delle Grazie in Milan asked Leonardo to paint a mural. Called *The Last Supper*, it was to feature Jesus and his 12 disciples (followers). The scene as described in the New Testament was the final meal they shared before one of them—Judas Iscariot—betrayed Jesus.

CHRISTIANITY

Christianity is a religion that dates from the early 1st century CE. It is based on the life and teachings of Jesus Christ, who lived in Galilee in the Middle East. Jesus's most devoted followers were called disciples. The Romans, who ruled Galilee at the time, persecuted Jesus and later crucified him, because they felt threatened by the spread of his beliefs.



Crucifixion, probably painted by Marcello Venusti in 1540